

him to be emperor. If he felt he had enough support, both from the troops and from the Senate, he could make a bid to replace an unpopular emperor. For this reason, an emperor

buy meat from the market! However, a handful of emperors, including Trajan, were great leaders, loved by their people and dreaded by their enemies. It was during

THE PRAETORIANS MURDERED AT LEAST 15 ROMAN EMPERORS.

could never afford to fall out with the army, and there was always a chance that one of the generals was plotting to overthrow him.

Emperors good and bad

About 175 men claimed the title of emperor during the 500 years of the Roman Empire. Between 235 and 284 CE, there were 21 official emperors and many more who tried to seize power but failed. Almost all died violent deaths, usually at the hands of their own soldiers.

Some emperors were tyrants, feared for their cruelty.

Caligula, for example, had prisoners killed and then fed them to the wild beasts kept at the arena, because it was cheaper to do this than to

Trajan's reign that the Roman Empire reached its greatest extent, and many new buildings were put up in Rome.

ON TRAJAN'S COLUMN IN ROME, THERE IS A RELIEF CARVING THAT SHOWS SCENES FROM THE EMPEROR'S BATTLE VICTORIES.

